

Model District AI Transparency Policy

A practical starting point for public AI disclosure, student data protection, and human review in K-12 schools.

Purpose

This model policy helps school districts use AI responsibly while giving students and families clear public information. It is not anti-AI. It is pro-transparency.

This document is a model policy template for school boards, district administrators, parents, students, and community advocates. It is designed to be adapted by a district and reviewed by appropriate legal counsel before adoption.

1. Public AI Tool Registry

- The district should maintain a public AI tool registry on its website.
- The registry should include AI-enabled tools used in instructional, administrative, counseling, monitoring, disciplinary, assessment, school safety, special education, or student-support contexts.
- For each tool, the district should identify the vendor, purpose, users, whether student data is processed, and whether the tool may influence high-impact educational decisions.
- The registry should include a district contact for questions about AI use.

2. Notice for High-Impact Uses

- Students and families should receive notice when AI-enabled tools are used in contexts that may materially affect a student.
- High-impact contexts include grading, discipline, academic placement, counseling or mental health triage, attendance intervention, monitoring or surveillance, plagiarism or misconduct detection, special education support, and college or career advising.
- Notice should be written in clear language that students and families can understand.

3. Human Review Before Serious Consequences

- AI should not be the sole basis for serious academic, disciplinary, placement, counseling, or educational record consequences.
- Before a serious consequence is imposed, a qualified district employee should review the relevant facts, the AI-generated output, and any student or family explanation.
- Human review should be meaningful, not merely a rubber stamp of an automated output.

4. Appeal and Correction Process

- Students and families should be able to request human review of AI-influenced decisions.
- The district should provide a process to request an explanation, correct inaccurate information, submit relevant context, and seek reconsideration.
- The appeal process should identify who reviews the request and the expected response timeline.

5. Student Data Protection

- Student data processed by AI-enabled tools should be limited to what is necessary for the educational purpose approved by the district.

- Student data should not be sold, used for unrelated advertising, or used for secondary model training unless explicitly permitted by law and district policy.
- The district should review vendor terms for data collection, retention, deletion, security, and model-training practices.
- District staff should avoid entering sensitive student information into AI tools that have not been approved for that purpose.

6. Vendor Contract Transparency

- District contracts with AI-enabled vendors should address data collection, data retention, deletion, security, model training, auditability, and limitations of AI outputs.
- The district should be able to explain whether a vendor uses student data to train, fine-tune, improve, or evaluate AI models.
- The district should maintain documentation of approved AI tools and procurement decisions.

7. Annual AI Transparency Report

- The district should publish an annual AI transparency report summarizing AI tools used, purposes of use, high-impact contexts, complaints or appeals, policy updates, and vendor changes.
- The report should be accessible to students, families, educators, and the public.
- The district should use the report to review whether AI tools are serving educational goals and whether additional safeguards are needed.

How a District Can Start

1. Publish a simple AI disclosure page on the district website.
2. List AI-enabled tools currently used by the district.
3. Identify whether student data is processed by each tool.
4. State where human review is required before serious consequences.
5. Provide a parent and student contact for questions.
6. Review vendor contracts for AI and data terms.
7. Update the AI disclosure page at least annually.

Suggested School Board Resolution Language

Resolution starter language

The Board directs the district to publish a public AI transparency page listing AI-enabled tools used in instructional, administrative, counseling, monitoring, disciplinary, assessment, or student-support contexts, and to develop procedures for student data protection, parent/student notice, and human review of AI-influenced high-impact decisions.

Contact and Coalition Information

Students for K-12 AI Transparency is recruiting student ambassadors, district advocates, research volunteers, policy volunteers, communications volunteers, and advisors.

Join form: <https://forms.gle/fhhreQ1nHUoaTuw86>

Contact: ronysbrand@gmail.com